

Class 10th Social Science

**Forest and Wildlife
Resources**

Geography





FOREST AND WILDLIFE RESOURCES



Narak! My Lord, you are the creator of music in the world of Lepchas

Oh Narak! My Lord, let me dedicate myself to you

Let me gather your music from the springs, the rivers, the mountains, the forests, the insects and the animals

Let me gather your music from the sweet breeze and offer it to you

Lepcha folk song

Flora and Fauna in India

If you look around, you will be able to find that there are some animals and plants which are unique in your area. In fact, India is one of the world's richest countries in terms of its vast array of biological diversity. This is possibly twice or thrice the number yet to be discovered. You have already studied in detail about the extent and variety of forest and wildlife resources in India. You may have realised the importance of these resources in our daily life. These diverse flora and fauna are so well integrated in our daily life that we take these for granted. But, lately, they are under great stress mainly due to insensitivity to our environment.

Activity

Find out stories prevalent in your region which are about the harmonious relationship between human beings and nature.

Conservation of Forest and Wildlife in India

Conservation in the background of rapid decline in wildlife population and forestry has become essential. But why do we need to conserve our forests and wildlife? Conservation preserves the ecological diversity and our life support systems – water, air and soil. It also preserves the genetic diversity of plants and animals for better growth of species and breeding. For example, in agriculture, we are still dependent on traditional crop varieties. Fisheries too are heavily dependent on the maintenance of aquatic biodiversity.

In the 1960s and 1970s, conservationists demanded a national wildlife protection programme. The Indian Wildlife (Protection)

Biodiversity or **Biological Diversity** is immensely rich in wildlife and cultivated species, diverse in form and function but closely integrated in a system through multiple network of interdependencies.

Chapter Summary

Forest and wildlife → why they are a resource?



- Intro
- need for Conservation.



Steps taken

- Steps taken by govt [Indian wildlife protection act, 1972, Project tiger]
- Steps taken by Community
- Types and distribution.

Steps taken by the Government for the Conservation of forest and wildlife?



Fig. 2.1

Ques What are the provisions in Indian wildlife protection act 1972?

Act was implemented in 1972 with various provisions for protecting habitats. An all-India list of protected species was also published. The thrust of the programme was towards protecting the remaining population of certain endangered species by banning hunting, giving legal protection to their habitats, and restricting trade in wildlife. Subsequently, central and many state governments established national parks and wildlife sanctuaries about which you have already studied. The central government also announced several projects for protecting specific animals, which were gravely threatened, including the tiger, the one-horned rhinoceros, the Kashmir stag or hangul, three types of crocodiles – fresh water crocodile, saltwater crocodile and the Gharial, the Asiatic lion, and others. Most recently, the Indian elephant, black buck (chinkara), the great Indian bustard (godawan) and the snow leopard, etc. have been given full or partial legal protection against hunting and trade throughout India.

Project Tiger

Tiger is one of the key wildlife species in the faunal web. In 1973, the authorities realised that the tiger population had dwindled to 1,827 from an estimated 55,000 at the turn of the century. The major threats to tiger population are numerous, such as poaching for trade, shrinking habitat, depletion of prey base species, growing human population, etc. The trade of tiger skins and the use of their bones in traditional medicines, especially in the Asian countries left the tiger population on the verge of extinction. Since India and Nepal provide habitat to about two-thirds of the surviving tiger population in the world, these two nations became prime targets for poaching and illegal trading.

"Project Tiger", one of the well-publicised wildlife campaigns in the world, was launched in 1973. Tiger conservation has been viewed not only as an effort to save an endangered species, but with





Fig. 2.2: Rhino and deer in Kaziranga National Park

equal importance as a means of preserving biotypes of sizeable magnitude.

Corbett National Park in Uttarakhand, Sunderbans National Park in West Bengal, Bandhavgarh National Park in Madhya Pradesh, Sariska Wildlife Sanctuary in Rajasthan, Manas Tiger Reserve in Assam and Periyar Tiger Reserve in Kerala are some of the tiger reserves of India.

- 4 The conservation projects are now focusing on biodiversity rather than on a few of its components. There is now a more intensive search for different conservation measures. Increasingly, even insects are beginning to find a place in conservation planning. In the notification under Wildlife Act of 1980 and 1986, several hundred butterflies, moths, beetles, and one dragonfly have been added to the list of protected species. In 1991, for the first time plants were also added to the list, starting with six species.
- 5
- 6

Activity

Collect more information on the wildlife sanctuaries and national parks of India and cite their locations on the map of India.

Types and Distribution of Forest and Wildlife Resources

Even if we want to conserve our vast forest and wildlife resources, it is rather difficult to manage, control and regulate them. In India,

much of its forest and wildlife resources are either owned or managed by the government through the Forest Department or other government departments. These are classified under the following categories.

- (i) **Reserved Forests:** More than half of the total forest land has been declared reserved forests. Reserved forests are regarded as the most valuable as far as the conservation of forest and wildlife resources are concerned.
- (ii) **Protected Forests:** Almost one-third of the total forest area is protected forest, as declared by the Forest Department. This forest land are protected from any further depletion.
- (iii) **Unclassed Forests:** These are other forests and wastelands belonging to both government and private individuals and communities.

Reserved and protected forests are also referred to as permanent forest estates maintained for the purpose of producing timber and other forest produce, and for protective reasons. Madhya Pradesh has the largest area under permanent forests, constituting 75 per cent of its total forest area. Jammu and Kashmir, Andhra Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, West Bengal, and Maharashtra have large percentages of reserved forests of its total forest area whereas Bihar, Haryana, Punjab, Himachal Pradesh, Odisha and Rajasthan have a bulk of it under protected forests. All North-



Which of the following characteristics of the Indian Wildlife (Protection) Act are correct ?
Choose the most appropriate option.

Characteristics:

- I. To make provisions for habitat for wild animals.
- II. To publish list of protected species
- III. To ban hunting to save endangered species.
- IV. To include important subjects like forests and wildlife in the Union List.

Options:

- ☒ (A) Only I, II and III are correct,
- (B) Only I, II and IV are correct.
- (C) Only II, III and IV are correct.
- (D) Only I, III and IV are correct.

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2026 - Set [32/4/2]

Match Column - I with Column - II and choose the correct option: |

Column - I (National Park)

Column - II (States)

a. Corbett

(i) Rajasthan

b. Sundarban

(ii) Uttarakhand

c. Sariska

(iii) Kerala

d. Periyar

(iv) West Bengal

Options:

~~(A) a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii~~

(B) a-ii, b-i, c-iv, d-iii

(C) a-iv, b-ii, c-iii, d-i

(D) a-ii, b-iv, c-i, d-iii

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2025 - Set [32/1/2]

Arrange the following categories of forests in India from the largest to the smallest in terms of area and choose the correct option:

I.Reserved

II.Protected

III.Unclassed

Options:

(A)III, II, I

(C) II, III, I

(B) I, II, III

(D)III, I, II

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2026 - Set [32/5/2]

In which of the following States of India, has the largest area under permanent forests?

- (A) Uttar Pradesh**
- (B) Madhya Pradesh**
- (C) Gujarat**
- (D) Maharashtra**

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2024 - Set [32/1/3]

Suggest any two measures for the conservation of forest.

2

↓
open ended Question

- illegal cutting of forest should be banned.
- Community should play important role.

Practice Question for this Topic

1.1.63

CBSE Board Paper 2024 - Set [32/1/3]

Suggest any two measures for the conservation of wildlife.

2

Open ended.

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2026 - Set [32/2/2]

Describe the main provisions of the Indian Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.

5

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⑤ Point discussed today.

Practice Question for this Topic

CBSE Board Paper 2026 - Set [32/2/2]

Describe any two characteristics of 'reserved forests' in India.

2